Mykola Kalakutskyi

Project, Delivery & Program Manager · Sofia, Bulgaria (EU)

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12+	18	400+	160+	$1.2M+	$400K
years in IT delivery	teams built from scratch	mentoring sessions and consultations	client projects delivered (2008–2018)	extra outsourcing revenue (pre-sales and upselling)	saved in one year (22% lower operating costs)

Summary

Project, delivery and program manager. 12+ years in IT, managing delivery and teams, in product companies, IT outsourcing and my own ventures. I run delivery for B2B and B2C products in iGaming, EdTech, HRTech, e-commerce and mobile, build teams from scratch and manage managers: up to 45 people in one department. Engineering background, product thinking and practical AI tooling in daily work.

Experience

06/2023 – present

Independent consultant and mentor

Own practice, parallel with employed roles · Remote

400+ consultations and mentoring sessions

- Delivered 400+ individual and group consultations, PM process audits and private mentoring sessions.
- Mentors project and product managers and helps managers at different levels with delivery, people and process problems.

09/2024 – 08/2026

Project & Product Manager

IT outsourcing and outstaffing company · Remote

3 products from discovery to production · 4 teams · 16% of a project budget saved

- Delivered 3 products from discovery to production across 4 cross-functional teams.
- Reused an existing platform with minimal customisation, cutting time-to-market by about 30%.
- Validated an early prototype with AI assistance, rejected an unproven hypothesis before development and saved 16% of the project budget.
- Managed a B2B casino and sportsbook platform from prototype through MVP, testing, production and live operations, including Android and iOS apps: an 8-person team, working directly with the client's CEO.
- Specified REST contracts, webhooks, status and error mapping and reconciliation for payment-provider integrations (e-wallets, vouchers, crypto).
- Coordinated KYC/AML integrations, GDPR requirements, rule-based fraud and risk controls, responsible-gambling tools and player segmentation.
- Introduced benchmark-derived player notifications: LTV +9% and a higher average deposit, proven with control-group A/B tests.
- Prioritised with RICE and ICE; defined hypotheses and success metrics, configured experiments and analysed funnels in Amplitude, Tableau and Google Analytics.
- Managed Fixed Price and Time & Materials delivery; estimated and agreed change requests before acceptance.
- Wrote PRDs, SRS, user stories, acceptance criteria and JTBD job stories.
- Introduced AI-assisted coding, testing, documentation and code review into team workflows and practised Spec-Driven Development.
- Delivered enterprise data and analytics projects for about 8 months.
- Coordinated incident response, urgent fixes and L1–L3 support under SLAs; negotiated and drafted operator contracts and worked with regulators on licensing.
- Replaced vendors across analytics, marketing, payments, legal, content and SaaS.

04/2024 – 09/2024

Senior Delivery Manager

International iGaming product company · Cyprus, on site

2 teams of 17 · 60+ projects a quarter · Lead Time -25%

- Managed 2 cross-functional teams of 17 people each, including PMs, developers, QA and designers.
- Coordinated 2 strategic initiatives and an average of 60+ short-term projects per quarter.
- Reduced Lead Time by 25% over six months by removing blockers and cross-team dependencies.
- Delivered an experimental product from idea to release in 4 months; it is live, well rated and scaling to Europe and the US.
- Managed B2C casino delivery and 4 concurrent iGaming mobile apps for Android and iOS in a licensed, strictly regulated sector.
- Stabilised a high-load app with an SLA on transactions during promotions: changed the cross-platform framework, added caching and proxying and moved duplicate-request handling for Kafka to the server side.
- Introduced lightweight reporting that gave senior management visibility of progress, blockers and risks.
- Hired for two experimental internal startups and for mobile delivery.

11/2021 – 06/2023

Program Manager

EdTech and HRTech product company · Ukraine, on site

Department of up to 45 · $400,000 saved in a year · 15+ releases

- Managed 3 product streams (HR and knowledge management, online schooling, education administration), B2B and B2C.
- Led a department of up to 45 people across product, engineering, design, QA, business analysis, DevOps and support; up to 11 managers and team leads reported directly. About 22 projects were supported at the same time.
- Saved $400,000 in one year through process improvements and supplier contract optimisation, including a 22% operating-expense reduction (tool and infrastructure costs plus process gains).
- Delivered 15+ releases with improvements in NPS, retention and partner satisfaction.
- Stabilised the department and retained 80%+ of the team and all key people through the full-scale invasion.
- Introduced Definition of Ready, Definition of Done and capacity planning as a hybrid process that fitted stakeholders with business constraints.
- Aligned 300+ stakeholders outside the reporting line and established a shared delivery-governance model across business, product, engineering, QA and DevOps.
- Owned budget forecasting, financial reporting and cost control.
- Proposed tablet-based QR sign-in for students: 9.9/10 satisfaction, then adopted across other products.
- Managed 2 subscription mobile apps in parallel and contributed to pricing, packaging and paywall tests.
- Mentored 3 PMs.

05/2020 – 10/2021

Senior IT Project Manager

IT outsourcing company · Ukraine, remote

8 concurrent projects · 25 developers · stakeholder satisfaction +25%

- Managed up to 8 concurrent client projects and teams with 25 developers under Fixed Price and T&M contracts.
- Coordinated distributed delivery across Ukraine, EU, US and UK clients; ran client workshops and interviews.
- Scope: web and mobile apps, online design tools, AR/VR and enterprise software; game development for about 1.5 years in total.
- Introduced the 4 DORA metrics, KPI dashboards and reporting templates.
- Led remote pre-sales scoping, proposals, estimation, RFP responses and account expansion.
- Proposed infrastructure improvements that generated additional profit; an SEO and promotion proposal raised another contract's value by 20% and improved margin.
- Raised stakeholder satisfaction by 25% and received internal recognition for project management.
- Mentored 7 PMs.

05/2016 – 10/2019

IT Project Manager

Web development studio (custom software for SMEs) · Ukraine

10+ client engagements of 2 to 3 years each

- Managed 10+ long-term client engagements, 2 to 3 years each, including Fixed Price projects with 8 developers.
- Rebuilt the development team and delivery processes after a staffing disruption.
- Assembled teams for specific ERP and e-commerce projects, first for development and then for support.
- Acted as Product Owner: translated business goals into requirements, priorities and user journeys.
- Managed scope, budget, schedules and releases; introduced Kanban, Jira, Confluence and structured reporting.
- Supported pre-sales and repeat business through product improvements and maintenance.

01/2016 – 09/2016

Product Owner

Electronic currency exchange · Ukraine

Contributed to profitability within six months

- Prioritised high-demand, high-margin exchange directions, payment integrations, merchant connectivity and automation.
- Optimised commissions, operating costs and UX using click-map analysis and contributed to profitability within six months.
- Built client support from scratch, including SLAs, standards and quality metrics.
- Managed daily operations, exchange-direction economics, staff training and process documentation.

01/2015 – 05/2018

Freelancer

Direct client work, parallel with employed roles · Ukraine

Translations, banners, SEO blogs, data tools

- Delivered technical translations and animated Flash advertising banners for international corporate clients.
- Developed and promoted entrepreneurs' blogs through SEO.
- Built parsers and migration tools for eBay, Amazon and AliExpress data.

12/2012 – 01/2015

Director of IT

Web development and digital promotion agency · Ukraine

100+ projects · 92% of target keywords in Google's top 5

- Acquired clients; negotiated and signed website-development and promotion contracts, including exclusive corporate engagements.
- Recruited, trained and led up to 9 people; completed 100+ projects and secured long-term maintenance engagements.
- SEO results: 92% of target keywords in Google's top 5 and 42% in the top 3.

01/2008 – 12/2012

Web Developer

Freelance web development under my own brand · Ukraine

60+ projects · a team of up to 12 freelancers

- Built websites on WordPress, Joomla and OpenCart; completed 60+ projects sourced through freelance platforms.
- Built a team of up to 12 freelancers covering design, SEO, content, development and testing.

Ventures

Companies I run or help run, next to my delivery roles.

Mimeon
CEO and Founder

A mobile app: an endless gallery of images with no text, where the feed is filtered and sorted by your own behavior and activity.

MyManager
CEO

An AI career manager: collects jobs daily, scores them against your CV and tracks your applications.

CyberField Net
COO

Online cybersecurity education: a practical course with mentoring.

Community and teaching

Non-commercial work, not counted as employment.

- Outstanding PM: Telegram channel about management, 900+ subscribers, since 01/2024
- PM Coffee Time: Founder and host of online meetups for project managers, since 10/2023
- **Team Challenge**: PM mentor in a community of 4,400+ members
- SkillsUp: Teacher of practical courses

Education and certifications

- Bachelor of Engineering, Automation Engineering (Computer Automation), Kyiv Polytechnic Institute, Ukraine
- Certified Project Manager (CPM), 2018
- Practical Product Management Course, 10/2025 – 03/2026
- Preparing for PMP and PRINCE2 (planned 2027); ITIL planned for 2027

Languages

- English: advanced (C1)
- Ukrainian: native
- Russian: native
- Greek: intermediate (B1)
- Czech: elementary (A2)

Tools

- Jira, Confluence, Linear, MS Project, Asana, Trello, ClickUp
- Miro, Figma, Notion, Slack, Google Workspace, Draw.io, Mermaid
- Postman, Swagger/OpenAPI, GitHub, GitLab
- Amplitude, Tableau, Google Analytics, Power BI or Grafana
- HubSpot, Zendesk
- Claude, Claude Code, ChatGPT and Codex, Gemini, Cursor, Perplexity